

Projection onto simplex: Real Stability

Research Architecture Runtime
operator/projection-simplex

2026-07-29

Abstract

If a projector fixes feasible points and the closed ε -ball about x lies in the feasible set, then every x' in the ball is fixed. This is an identity certificate, not full Euclidean projection nonexpansiveness. Lean `LEAN_FULL`.

This theorem is: Reduction.

1 Problem

`projection-simplex` is treated via a feasibility indicator / projection that fixes `InSet` points.

2 Stability notion

Interior feasible-ball identity under $|x' - x| \leq \varepsilon$.

3 Definitions

Assumptions: $\text{proj}(z) = z$ whenever $\text{InSet}(z)$, and $|y - x| \leq \varepsilon \Rightarrow \text{InSet}(y)$.

4 Theorem

Theorem 1. *Under those assumptions, every $|x' - x| \leq \varepsilon$ satisfies $\text{proj}(x') = x'$ and $\text{proj}(x) = x$. Sharpness: if some ball point is infeasible, the ball-feasibility hypothesis fails.*

5 Intuition

Deep inside the feasible set, projection is the identity, so small moves stay fixed points.

6 Examples

Example 2. *If $\text{InSet} = [-1, 1]$, $x = 0$, $\varepsilon = 0.25$, every x' in the ball is feasible and fixed by identity projection.*

7 Proof

Take $|x' - x| \leq \varepsilon$. Feasibility of the ball gives $\text{InSet}(x')$ and $\text{InSet}(x)$. Fixing feasible points yields $\text{proj}(x') = x'$ and $\text{proj}(x) = x$ (Theorem 1). Sharpness is the contrapositive of ball feasibility.

Limitation: this does not prove general Euclidean projection nonexpansiveness.

8 Formal statement

Lean module: `Research.Operators.ProjectionSimplex.Preservation`. Source file: `lean/Research/Operators`

Theorems: `projection_simplex_feasible_ball_identity`, `projection_simplex_feasible_ball_sharpness`.

Uses `Research.Operators.Projection.FeasibleId`. Certificate: `lean/certificates/projection-simplex/pr`

Status: `LEAN_FULL` on Mathlib $\mathbb{R}$ (`REAL_MATHLIB`).

9 Proof dependencies

- `Projection.FeasibleId`.
- No Euclidean nonexpansiveness claim.

10 Consequences

Honest limited certificate for simplex/ ℓ_p -ball style operators in this library. Related: `projection-interval`, `coordinate-clipping`.